



Think Higher. Think College.

New Resources and Strategies
on College Access for Students
with Intellectual Disability



ThinkCollege
INCLUSIVE HIGHER EDUCATION NETWORK
INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

What is Think College?

www.thinkcollege.net

Think College is a national technical assistance, training, research, and evaluation center dedicated to developing, expanding, and improving higher education options for students with intellectual disability.

We work through several specific projects:

 **ThinkCollege**
**NATIONAL
COORDINATING
CENTER**

 **ThinkCollege**
**INCLUSIVE
HIGHER
EDUCATION
NETWORK**
INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

 **ThinkCollege**
**FUTURE
QUEST
ISLAND
EXPLORATIONS**

 **TRANSITION
LEADERSHIP
CERTIFICATION**
**UMASS
BOSTON** **SCHOOL FOR GLOBAL
INCLUSION AND
SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT**



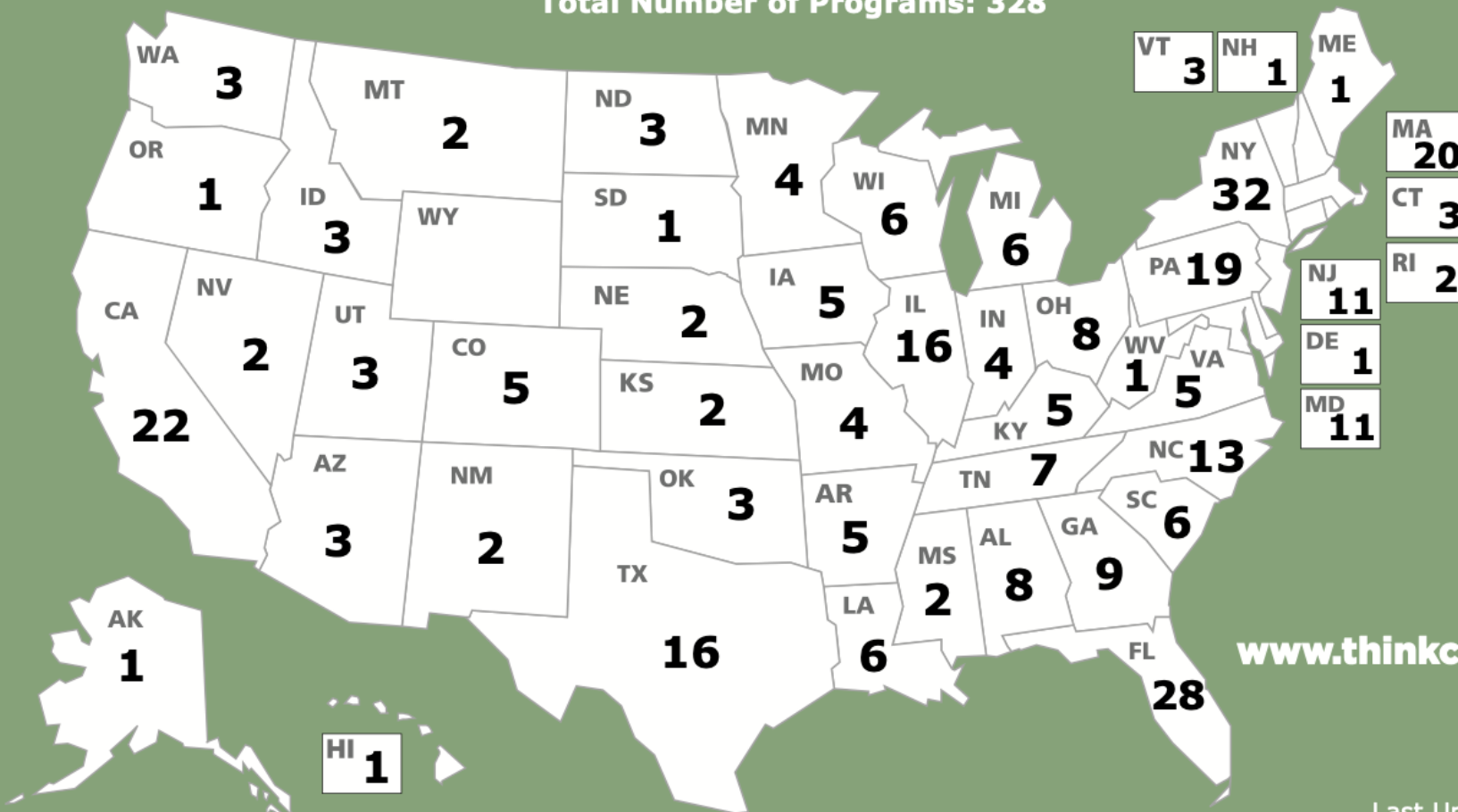
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College Options for Students with Intellectual Disability, October 2023

Total Number of Programs: 328



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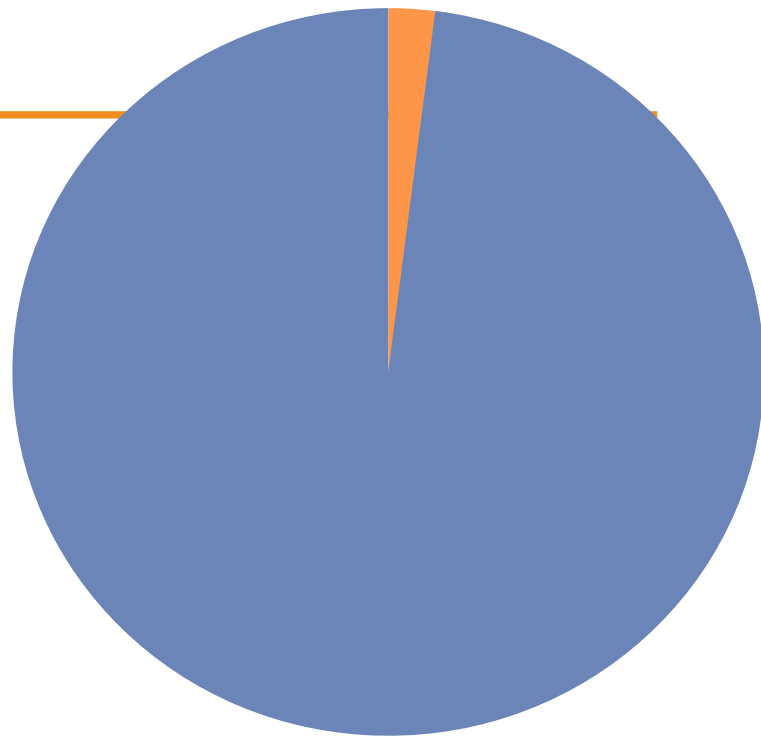
Last Updated: 10/2/23

This year...

- There are more than 420,000 school age students with intellectual disability in the United States¹
- Fewer than 2% are likely to attend college after high school

1. National Core Indicators, 2022

Students with ID attending college 2%



Students with ID who do not attend college 98%

For the 98% of adults with intellectual disability who don't go to college - the current reality

- Only 15% have paid employment in the community²
- 42% attend a day program or sheltered workshop²
- 44% report they often or sometimes feel lonely²
- 29.3% live below the poverty line³

2. National Core Indicators, 2022

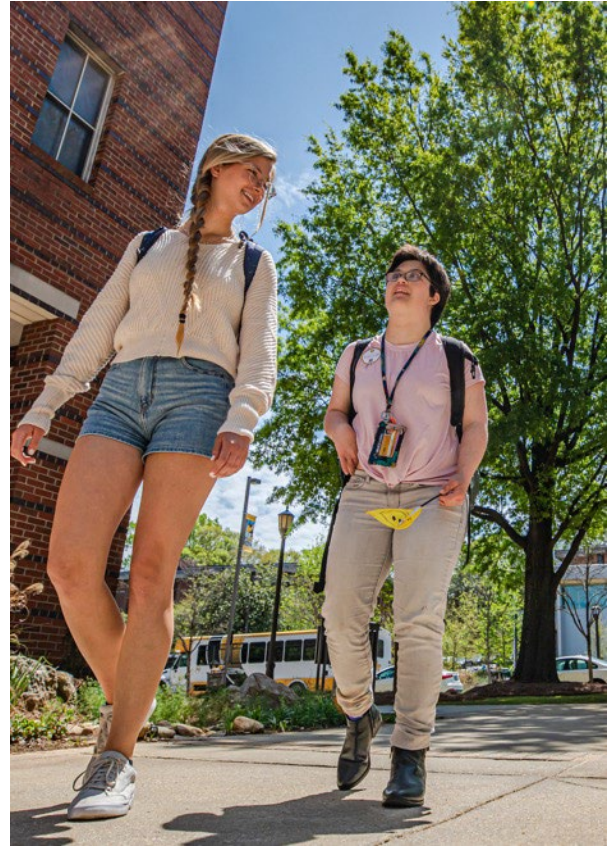
3. Winsor et al., 2022

For the 2% who attend postsecondary education, the outcomes are promising...

- 59% find competitive, integrated employment 1 year after exit⁴
- 87% of students were enrolled in a credential program^{4*}
- 100% of programs provided peer mentor support to students^{4*}

4. Grigal et al., 2022, 5. Smith et al., 2018

*based on TPSID model demonstration sites, not representative of all programs in the US





What if every young adult with intellectual disability in the United States saw college as an option?



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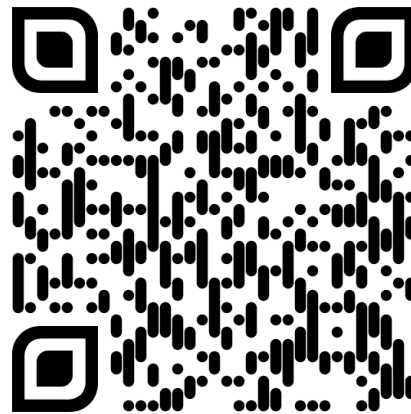
During or after the video, share in the chat any moments or quotes that caught your attention or impacted you.





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Sign up to stay
in the loop



Sign up link will also
be shared in the chat

<https://tcollege.me/join>



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“Think Higher. Think College.”

[Watch the video](#)

[Download the video](#)

[Watch](#) or [download](#) audio described and captioned version

<https://thinkhighered.net>



RESOURCES FOR EVERYONE

Think College created over 10 new products to share the
Think Higher. Think College. message

INCLUDING

- ✓ An IPSE resource guide
- ✓ Educational handouts, posters & postcards
- ✓ Social media & dissemination toolkit
- ✓ Easy-to-share social media content



EXPLORE AND DOWNLOAD
RESOURCES ON GOOGLE DRIVE


Think Higher. Think College.



Take Action!



- Show the video to anyone and everyone!
- Send campaign materials to families or educators
- Share publications and video at transition conferences or college fair
- Share during an IEP/person-centered planning meetings
- Add link to www.thinkhighered.net on your website
- Spread the word on social media
- Download the [poster](#) and hang it in your office or classroom

The "Think Higher. Think College." campaign is raising awareness of opportunities for students with intellectual disability to access higher education. The campaign video, website, and resources can help spark understanding, promote conversations, and encourage viewers to learn more and share the idea in their own communities that college is possible for students with intellectual disability.

Here are some ways you can share these resources with your community, educators, schools, and families.

Online

- » Download our social media kit at https://bit.ly/THTC_Social_Media_Kit for everything you'll need to promote inclusive postsecondary education on social media
- » Share the website <https://thinkhighered.net/> on social media
- » Include the campaign logo and a link to <https://thinkhighered.net/> in your newsletter and on your organization webpage
- » Use these hashtags: #THTC #ThinkHigher #ThinkCollege #ThinkHigherThinkCollege

In Person

Share the video, website, and resources:

- » At meetings or events for middle and high school students and staff, including guidance counselors, special educators, vocational rehabilitation professionals, and transition staff
- » During transition fairs, college fairs, and local and regional education conferences
- » With college and university staff and faculty who may be new to including students with intellectual disability on campus
- » With current college students with intellectual disability and their families, and ask them to share with their networks

Find resources to share, including the campaign video in three formats (4-minute video with captions, 6-minute video with captions and audio description, and 1-minute video with captions) at <https://thinkhighered.net/resources/>

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Screenshot

What will you do?



Share your plans for using the "Think Higher. Think College." campaign video and resources in the chat!